

The Hit Zones

Team 063

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Abstract

Understanding. Fans want understanding. They want to understand the game of baseball when they watch it, not just out of a desire for enjoyment but also out of a desire to stay informed. While at an MLB game recently, I overheard the gentleman next to me discussing his troubles reading the scoreboard, “there’s so much information up there, I just can’t read it all.” Thinking about what he said, made me realize I share his sentiment to a degree. At games I do see dozens of numbers and stats littered across the scoreboards, which while useful and often necessary, can also act as information overload at times.

With this dynamic in mind, I sought to create a simple, yet effective graphic that tells us something about the type of hitter up to bat. A graphic that would be displayed on the scoreboard for each batter throughout the course of a game. This is where the hit zones come into play, splitting the field into three regions and showing where a batter has historically hit the ball. The idea is to provide quicker and digestible visual context for the fans as to the type of hitter they are watching. Is it a pull hitter? Do they enjoy some oppo tacos from time to time? Do their hit zones indicate a more balanced approach at the plate? These are the questions I seek to shed light on.